

Jindal to question the value he would bring to the company, which boasted of stellar engineering talent. After discussions with his father and advisors, Jindal decided to study economics and business instead. “Being an engineer adds tremendous value to the business, but there is so much more—other than technical aspects—that, if I were an engineer, I could never learn,” he says.

That quest for a deeper understanding of business led to a one-and-a-half-year stint as a consultant at the Boston Consulting Group (BCG) after his degree, before he joined JSL as its Vice Chairman in November 2015. It was at BCG that tremendous learning occurred, and Jindal is still trying to embed some of those insights into his company. “I was part of different industries and a different discipline—in the cement industry, the focus was on

sales and marketing; in wind energy, on project execution; and then in auto components, on vendor management.” But as he was preparing for an MBA course, he was called back home. JSL had hit its lowest market capitalisation level, so he joined the company. “It was a real tough time when I entered... it was baptism by fire.”

To identify where the problem was, Jindal started by interacting with people on the ground—the suppliers, customers, and other stakeholders. He realised the company’s biggest concern was delivery. The initial loose-ended commitment of six to eight weeks posed challenges, with orders being fulfilled in as little as four weeks or taking as long as 16 weeks. He zeroed in on the pain point: the supply chain. Jindal dedicated two years to streamlining it. Transitioning from a ‘Made to



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